

Winning Slide

The fastest Indian on ice stays seriously cool.

Shiva Kesavan, 28, is the first Indian to qualify for

the 2010 Winter Olympics, his fourth. It is the rare athlete who competes in so many Games. It's been a tough haul though, and not only because Kesavan once lugged his luge and 60 kg of gear from airport to station. The first Indian to win an international medal in winter sports, Kesavan has touched 148 kph in his luge, which has no engine.



Netting the Role

Malayalam and Tamil actor **Padmapriya** is all set to make her Bollywood debut in Chandan Arora's *Striker* opposite Siddharth. The film is based on the life of a carrom board player and will see Padmapriya in a traditional Maharashtrian sari. "It was her passionate approach to work that made me cast her," says Arora. Quite a catch, eh?



"I have sung the *tappa* in its pure form. This award is in recognition of a musical form that has few takers today."

Shaashwati Mandal Paul, vocalist, on being nominated Best New-comer and the Best Artist in the Songlines World Music Awards 2009.

FASHION PACKED

Her label might be called Little Shilpa, but accessory designer **Shilpa Chavan** is big on talent. The tiny powerhouse took to the ramp at the Lakme Fashion Week and is already getting international orders for her Obi belts, neckpieces and headgear. "A gallery in the Middle East has asked me to do an installation. It should be interesting," says Chavan. Good things do come in small packages.



Photographs by BHASKAR PAUL



Lip Smackingly International

